

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 700

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to commend Calvary Baptist Church on the occasion of its 100th anniversary.

WHEREAS, the churches of our nation have been an integral part of our history as a people and have had an unparalleled impact in forming and maintaining a stable and just society; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should recognize those venerable religious institutions and their congregations who, through their unflagging capacity for love, dedication of spirit, and faith in God, strive to enrich the lives of people in their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such dynamic community of faith is that of Calvary Baptist Church in Morristown, whose members will celebrate the church's 100th anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, Calvary Baptist Church was organized on March 30, 1926, with twenty-three charter members who established their church across the tracks near Rheatown; the original members came from First Baptist Morristown, Montvue Baptist Church, and old Second Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Marshall Hoover was called as Calvary Baptist Church's first pastor, and he was followed in the pulpit over the next 100 years by a succession of dedicated pastors, including Reverend John Ogan, Reverend J.C. Davis, Reverend James Lyle, Reverend T.T. Lewis, Reverend Cecil Mills, Reverend L.W. Vandergriff, Reverend S.D. Rhodes, Reverend Eugene Moore, Reverend Darrell Seal, Reverend Carl Triplet, Dr. Clyde Martin, Reverend Mike Henegar, Reverend Jim Fanning, Reverend Sidney Nichols, and Dr. Larry Parrott; and

WHEREAS, in the 1930s, Calvary Baptist Church's membership split, with one group of parishioners getting the building and the other the church furnishings; Calvary Baptist Church today still has that original pulpit; and

WHEREAS, Calvary Baptist Church rented an old unpainted store building that had two stories, the downstairs served as the sanctuary and the upstairs was the Sunday school space and where the pastor lived; and

WHEREAS, leaving the rented building, Calvary Baptist Church purchased a lot at the corner of Rosedale and Harrison streets and constructed a tent for worship; concrete blocks were constructed on site, and the church building was quickly erected and completed by 1939; and

WHEREAS, in 1952, a Sunday school wing and choir space were added as well as the front porch and steps; spreading its wings to help launch other congregations, Calvary Baptist Church assisted in the establishment of Calvue Baptist Church and Morningside Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, continuing to grow over the decades, Calvary Baptist Church bought a parsonage, launched a bus ministry, and dedicated a new building in 1979 to meet the need for more space; and

WHEREAS, as the church celebrates 100 years of service, it continues to be a light in the community, and the devout members of the congregation have faithfully striven to carry out God's work in the world; and

WHEREAS, Calvary Baptist Church is truly one of the great religious institutions and catalysts for positive spiritual change in our State and nation, and the members of this exceptional congregation should be appropriately honored for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we join in the celebration of the 100th anniversary of Calvary Baptist Church, thank the good people of this congregation and their ministers for their

notable service to their Lord and the State of Tennessee, and wish them much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.